Individual Artifact Reflections

GEC 6: VISUAL ARTS E-PORTFOLIO

> *Each artifact in this portfolio is accompanied by a personal reflection — a written account of the creative process, the challenges encountered, the lessons internalized, and the connections drawn to my life and career as a BSIT student.*
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> *These are not merely summaries or academic reports; they are honest, introspective accounts of a technology student learning to think like an artist, ultimately discovering that the two disciplines were never as different as they seemed.*

Reflection on Art Activity 1

Finding structure in creative freedom and realizing how much visual instinct I had already developed through years of coding.

When I was first presented with the prompt for Art Activity 1, I experienced a momentary blank-canvas paralysis. As an Information Technology student, my typical "canvas" is an Integrated Development Environment (IDE) where every line of code serves a strict, logical, and predefined purpose. The prospect of unconstrained creative freedom felt intimidating, almost chaotic. I initially viewed art as a discipline entirely divorced from the systematic rigor of programming.

However, as I began to conceptualize the piece, a fascinating shift occurred. I realized that the blank page was no different from a newly initialized project repository. Without consciously intending to, I found myself applying principles of user interface (UI) and user experience (UX) design to my artwork. I instinctively sought balance, mapped out a grid system in my mind, and established a visual hierarchy so that the viewer's eye would follow a logical path across the page.

This activity was a revelation. It taught me that "creative freedom" does not mean an absence of structure; rather, it is the ability to invent your own structures. It made me realize that the countless hours I spent analyzing the aesthetics of software applications, debugging front-end CSS layouts, and agonizing over the padding of a digital button had inadvertently trained my visual instincts. I wasn't starting from scratch as an artist; I was simply translating my technical logic into a new, visual syntax.

Reflection on the Visual Elements Quiz

The moment theory met practice, and I stopped memorizing definitions and started seeing elements everywhere.

In most academic subjects, a quiz is merely a test of rote memorization. Initially, I treated the material for the Visual Elements Quiz exactly like that. I created mental flashcards: Line is a mark with length and direction; Shape is a closed two-dimensional area; Value is the lightness or darkness of a color. It felt akin to memorizing syntax for a new programming language—necessary, but abstract and somewhat disconnected from practical application.

But studying for this assessment triggered an unexpected paradigm shift. The definitions refused to stay confined to my notes. When I looked away from the study materials and glanced at the applications on my phone, the websites I browsed, and even the architecture of our campus, the theory suddenly materialized into practice. I wasn't just seeing a "login screen"; I was observing how complementary colors were used to draw attention to the call-to-action button, and how implied lines created a structured flow from the header down to the footer.

This quiz marked the crucial moment where I transitioned from passive memorization to active observation. Understanding the visual elements gave me a forensic toolkit to deconstruct the world around me. In the context of my BSIT degree, this means I no longer look at a user interface and simply ask, "Does it work?" I now ask, "How do the shapes, values, and textures communicate its function to the user?"

Reflection on the Video Reporting Activity

Discovering that presenting visually to an audience is a design problem with a human solution.

The Video Reporting Activity was arguably the most challenging artifact to produce, as it required the synthesis of everything we had learned into a dynamic, time-based medium. Compiling the research and drafting the script was straightforward—that was the data gathering phase. The true challenge lay in the execution: how to deliver this information visually and audibly in a way that resonated with an audience.

I quickly realized that presenting is fundamentally a design problem, and the "user" in this scenario is the viewer. If I overcrowded a slide with text, I was creating a poor user experience, resulting in cognitive overload. If my pacing was too fast, it was akin to a system lagging and dropping frames.

Every visual asset I chose to display on screen had to justify its existence by enhancing the narrative, not distracting from it.

Through the iterations of editing this video report, I learned a profound lesson about empathy in design. It forced me to step outside my own head and anticipate the viewer's needs, attention span, and emotional response. Whether I am rendering an educational video for GEC 6 or designing a complex database dashboard for a client in the future, the core objective remains exactly the same: taking complex information and shaping it into an accessible, engaging, and human-centric experience.

Clifford Niño F. Gerona

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